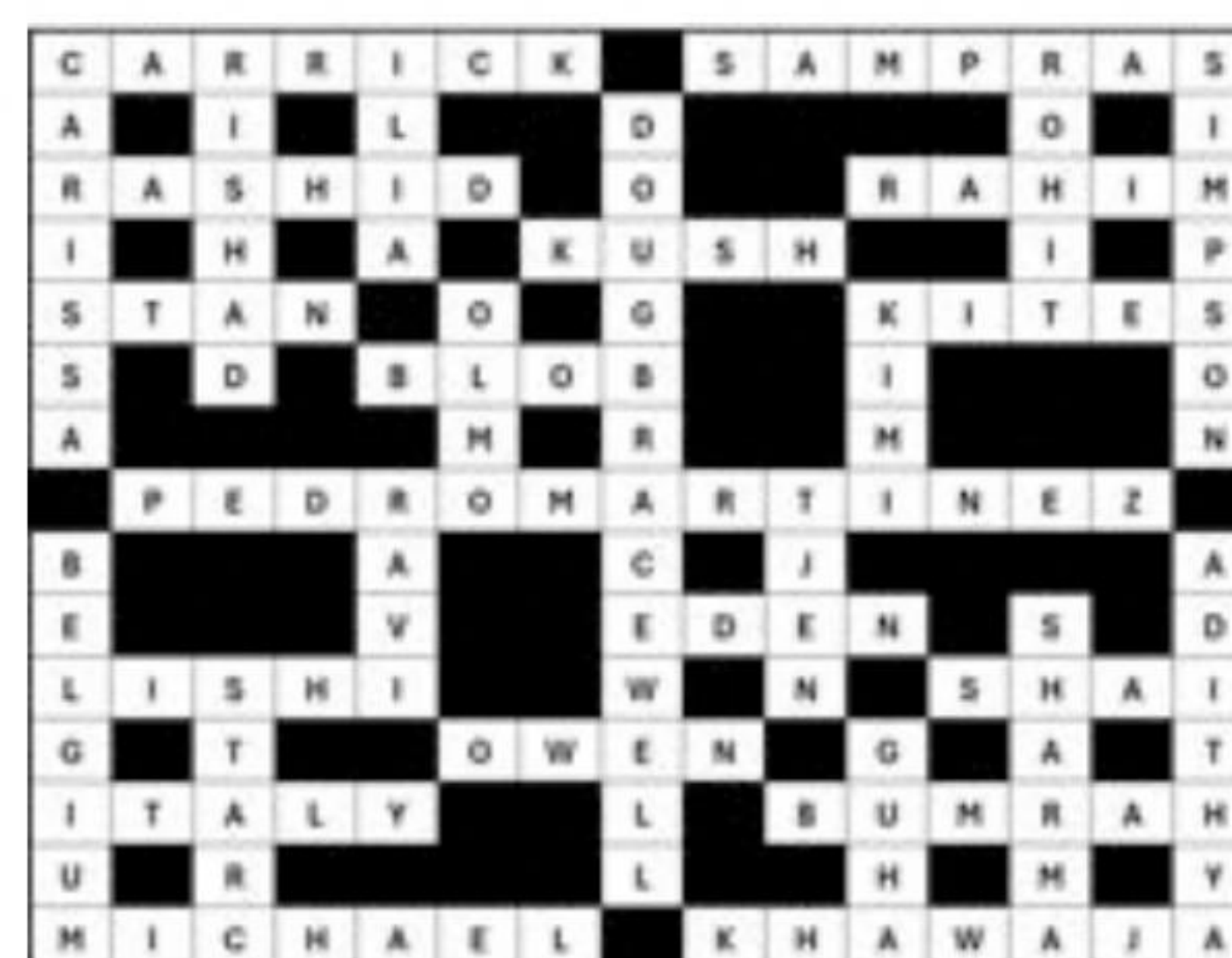
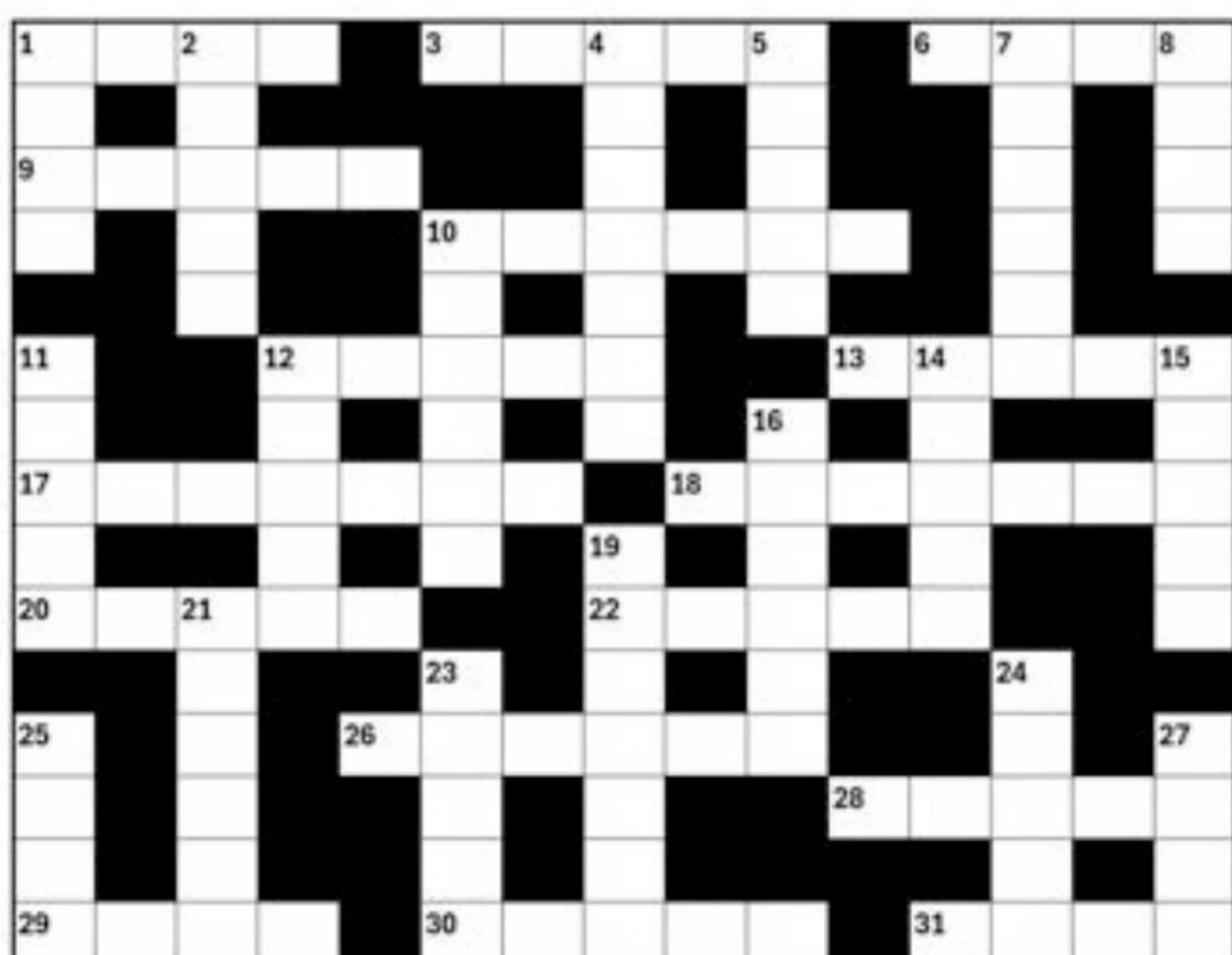


CROSSWORD

N. SOORYA PRAKASH



SOLUTION TO LAST FORTNIGHT'S CROSSWORD

ACROSS

- 1** Identify the first name of this cricketer who was the Player of the Series in the recent Vijay Hazare Trophy. (4)
- 3** Identify the surname of this Australian cricketer who replaced Nathan Lyon in the playing XI for the second Ashes Test at the Gabba and took 5 for 42 in the second innings. (5)
- 9** Who won the prestigious U.S. Open golf in 2025? (5)
- 10 & 6** Who finished as top goal-scorer of the Sultan of Johar Cup for hockey in 2025? (6,4)
- 12** Identify the first name of this player who won the Open Rapid title at the Tata Steel chess India 2025 held in January 2026. (5)
- 13** Identify the first name of this Indian cricketer who took a fifer in the Under-19 World Cup versus USA. (5)
- 17** Identify the surname of this chess player from USA who won both Rapid and Blitz titles in Saint Louis in August 2025 which is part of the Grand Chess Tour. (7)
- 18** Identify the first name of this cricketer who won the Player of the Series award in the T20I series in the Caribbean in July 2025. (7)
- 20** Identify the first name of this spinner from Pakistan who took a hat-trick in a T20I tri-series against Zimbabwe on November 23, 2025. (5)
- 26** Identify the first name of this former India spinner who is appointed as the spin bowling coach of Punjab Kings. (6)
- 28** Identify the first name of this Indian badminton star who announced her retirement recently. (5)

- 29** Identify the surname of this English cricketer who won the Player of the Series award in the recent ODI series versus Sri Lanka. (4)
- 30** Identify the former World No. 1 American tennis player who returned to the WTA circuit in 2025 and was also given a wild card in the 2026 Australian Open. (5)
- 31** Identify the surname of this cricketer who holds the record of making the highest Test score in an innings by an Indian captain. (4)

DOWN

- 1** FTB: South Korean ____-Young, won the women's singles title at the Indian Open badminton. (2,2)
- 2** Identify the first name of this cricketer who, in November 2025, became only the third player in the world to score six sixes in an over in First-Class history. (5)
- 4 & Across 22** Who won the Player of the Match award in the recent Women's World Cup final? (7,5)
- 5** Identify the first name of this Indian athlete who won the 4x400m women's relay and 4x400m mixed relay golds and silver in 400m at the 2025 Asian Athletic Championships in Gumi, in May 2025. (5)
- 7** Identify the first name of this player who was adjudged best in the Sultan of Johor Cup for hockey in 2025. (6)
- 8** Identify the Indian doubles player who qualified for the Australian Open 2026 for the first time in his career but lost in the first round. (4)
- 10** Identify the surname of the cricketer who holds the world record of having

- scored the fastest triple century in Tests. (6)
- 11** Identify the surname of this Dutch footballer who played for VFL Bochum Team in Bundesliga last season and scored a hat-trick before contracted by PSV Eindhoven. (5)
- 12** Identify the surname of this Indian athlete who won women's 200m gold in the 2016 South Asian Games, bronze at the 4x100m relay in the Commonwealth Games in 2010 and participated in the 200m in the 2016 Rio Olympics. (5)
- 14** Identify the first name of the player who won the women's singles at the Australian Open in 2026. (5)
- 15 & 24** Who took most wickets in the ODI series between Australia and South Africa in August 2025? (5,5)
- 16** Identify the surname of this Indian who conceptualised and produced the biopic, Saina. (6)
- 19** Which EPL football team plays its home matches at Hill Dickinson Stadium? (7)
- 21** Which country won the CONCACAF Gold Cup in 2025? (6)
- 23** Identify the first name of this all-rounder from Rajasthan, who played for India A in the T20 World Cup warm-up match versus USA. (5)
- 25** Identify the first name of this Brazilian who scored a hat-trick for Brentford in the Premier League match against Everton on January 4, 2026. (4)
- 27** Identify the first name of the cricketer who recently became the most capped player in T20 Internationals in the world. (4)